asked if the name on the paper I held was ‘Geetha’. I looked once again at the paper on which my daughter’s name was written.

I asked for a repeat trial, still holding the same name in my hand. Dr Lahari asked the same set of questions in a different order. This time, too, the graph corresponding to ‘Geetha’ showed marked variation. I agreed to take the test.

The questions were a mix of different things in no particular order. It was clear that the intention was not to test one’s values, but to detect the lie from a bunch of truths.

Samples:

Is your name Nambi Narayanan?

Do you work with the ISRO?

Have you met Mariam Rasheeda?

Have you received money from Fauziyya Hassan?

Do you know Raman Srivastava?

Have you ever stolen anything from your house when you were a child?

Have you done any crime?

Have you stolen anything from your office?

Do you think Sasikumaran would have done some espionage?

Have you met Zuheira?

Have you received any cash from a Pakistani?

The questions went on, some sets repeating in different combinations. At the end of it, Dr Lahari sat glued to the monitor. His eyes were moist. There was not a single lie.

Dr Lahari got my signature on all the graphs and reports. I went back to my room.

A LIFE LOST, TWO SAVED

‘Can you help us save a baby?’